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Inventor(s)	Wei; Yaguang et al.

Air conditioning control system

Abstract

An air conditioning control system transmits control content to an air conditioning apparatus and adjusts an environmental state in a target space. The air conditioning control system includes an acquisition unit and a control content determination unit. The acquisition unit acquires a target environmental state. The control content determination unit has a learning model having an input and an output. The input is the target environmental state. The output is determined control content. The determined control content is the control content to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus in order to bring the target space closer to the target environmental state. The learning model has been trained by using, as a learning dataset, learning control content and a learning environmental state. The learning control content is the control content for the air conditioning apparatus. The learning environmental state is the environmental state in the target space.

Inventors:	Wei; Yaguang (Osaka, JP), Mashita; Tomohiro (Suita, JP), Kanayama; Tetsuya (Suita, JP), Ratsamee; Photchara (Suita, JP), Uranishi; Yuki (Suita, JP)
Applicant:	DAIKIN INDUSTRIES, LTD. (Osaka, JP)
Family ID:	1000008781003
Assignee:	DAIKIN INDUSTRIES, LTD. (Osaka, JP)
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Primary Examiner: Choi; Michael W

Attorney, Agent or Firm: GLOBAL IP COUNSELORS, LLP

Background/Summary**CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS**

(1) This U.S. National stage application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a) to Japanese Patent Application Nos. 2020-055108, filed in Japan on Mar. 25, 2020 and 2020-138933, filed in Japan on Aug. 19, 2020, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND**Technical Field**

(2) The present disclosure relates to an air conditioning control system.

Background Art

(3) There is a technique of determining control content of an air conditioning apparatus so as to bring a target space of an air conditioning operation performed by the air conditioning apparatus into an environmental state desired by a user. In Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication (Translation of PCT Application) No. 2019-522163, control content of an air conditioning apparatus is determined by using a learning system including a reinforcement learning algorithm and measurement values obtained from sensors at various locations in a target space.

SUMMARY

(4) In reinforcement learning, a reward function is determined in accordance with an environmental state desired by a user, a value function is learned by using the reward function, and control content of the air conditioning apparatus is determined. Thus, in a case where control content of the air conditioning apparatus is to be determined in real time, the method using reinforcement learning involves an issue that a relatively long time is taken.

(5) An air conditioning control system according to a first aspect is configured to transmit control content to an air conditioning apparatus and adjust an environmental state in a target space of an air conditioning operation performed by the air conditioning apparatus. The air conditioning control system includes an acquisition unit and a control content determination unit. The acquisition unit is configured to acquire a target environmental state. The target environmental state is the environmental state to be achieved. The control content determination unit has a learning model. The learning model has an input. The input is the target environmental state. The learning model has an output. The output is determined control content. The determined control content is the control content to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus for bringing the target space closer to the target environmental state. The learning model has been trained by using, as a learning dataset, learning control content and a learning environmental state. The learning control content is the control content for the air conditioning apparatus. The learning environmental state is the

environmental state in the target space.

(6) In the air conditioning control system according to the first aspect, the air conditioning control system determines, by using the learning model, determined control content to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus for bringing the target space closer to the target environmental state. The learning model is a trained model. Thus, the air conditioning control system is capable of determining, in more real time, the determined control content for achieving the target environmental state.

(7) An air conditioning control system according to a second aspect is the air conditioning control system according to the first aspect, in which the target environmental state is the environmental state to be achieved in a partial space. The partial space is a part of the target space. The determined control content is the control content to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus for bringing the partial space closer to the target environmental state. The learning environmental state is the environmental state in the partial space.

(8) In the air conditioning control system according to the second aspect, the target environmental state is the environmental state to be achieved in a partial space. The partial space is a part of the target space. The determined control content is the control content to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus for bringing the partial space closer to the target environmental state. The learning environmental state is the environmental state in the partial space. Thus, the air conditioning control system is capable of bringing a part of the target space into the environmental state to be achieved in a pinpoint manner.

(9) An air conditioning control system according to a third aspect is the air conditioning control system according to the second aspect, in which the partial space is a predetermined three-dimensional region in the target space.

(10) In the air conditioning control system according to the third aspect, the partial space is a predetermined three-dimensional region in the target space. Thus, the air conditioning control system is capable of bringing the predetermined three-dimensional region in the target space into the environmental state to be achieved.

(11) An air conditioning control system according to a fourth aspect is the air conditioning control system according to the second aspect, in which the partial space is a predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space.

(12) In the air conditioning control system according to the fourth aspect, the partial space is a predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space. Thus, the air conditioning control system is capable of bringing the predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space into the environmental state to be achieved.

(13) An air conditioning control system according to a fifth aspect is the air conditioning control system according to any of the first aspect to the fourth aspect, in which the learning environmental state is an output result of one or more simulations performed by using the learning control content as an input.

(14) In the air conditioning control system according to the fifth aspect, the air conditioning control system performs one or more simulations by using the learning control content as an input, and acquires the learning environmental state. Thus, the air conditioning control system is capable of easily acquiring the learning dataset.

(15) An air conditioning control system according to a sixth aspect is the air conditioning control system according to any of the first aspect to the fifth aspect, in which the control content is an air conditioning control parameter including an amount regarding at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity.

(16) An air conditioning control system according to a seventh aspect is the air conditioning control system according to any of the first aspect to the sixth aspect, in which the environmental state is an environmental parameter at one or more locations in the target space. The environmental parameter includes an amount regarding at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction,

air volume, and air velocity.

(17) An air conditioning control system according to an eighth aspect is the air conditioning control system according to any one of the first aspect to the seventh aspect, in which the target environmental state is determined based on a desire regarding the environmental state input via a user interface.

(18) In the air conditioning control system according to the eighth aspect, a user sets the target environmental state via the user interface. Thus, the user is able to easily set a desired target environmental state.

(19) An air conditioning control system according to a ninth aspect is the air conditioning control system according to any of the first aspect to the eighth aspect, in which the learning dataset further includes space layout information. The space layout information is information on an object in the target space.

(20) In the air conditioning control system according to the ninth aspect, the learning dataset further includes space layout information. The space layout information is information on an object in the target space. Thus, the amount of information to be learned by the learning model increases, and the accuracy of the determined control content output by the learning model increases.

(21) An air conditioning control system according to a tenth aspect is the air conditioning control system according to the ninth aspect, in which the space layout information includes, as the information on the object in the target space, information regarding an amount of heat.

(22) An air conditioning control system according to an eleventh aspect is the air conditioning control system according to any of the first aspect to the tenth aspect, in which the learning dataset further includes arrangement information of one or more air outlets of one or more air conditioning apparatuses.

(23) In the air conditioning control system according to the eleventh aspect, the learning dataset further includes arrangement information of one or more air outlets of one or more air conditioning apparatuses. Thus, the amount of information to be learned by the learning model increases, and the accuracy of the determined control content output by the learning model increases.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1A is a schematic diagram of an air conditioning control system.

(2) FIG. 1B is a schematic diagram of the air conditioning control system.

(3) FIG. 1C is a schematic diagram of the air conditioning control system.

(4) FIG. 1D is a schematic diagram of the air conditioning control system.

(5) FIG. 2 is a configuration diagram of the air conditioning control system.

(6) FIG. 3A is a configuration diagram of an environmental state display process.

(7) FIG. 3B is a configuration diagram of a control content change process.

(8) FIG. 3C is a configuration diagram of a learning process.

(9) FIG. 3D is a configuration diagram of the learning process.

(10) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating control content.

(11) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating learning control content.

(12) FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating a temperature distribution in a target space visualized by using an environmental state (CFD).

(13) FIG. 7A illustrates an environmental distribution diagram of temperature.

(14) FIG. 7B illustrates an environmental distribution diagram of air velocity.

(15) FIG. 8A is a flowchart of an environmental state display process.

(16) FIG. 8B is the flowchart of the environmental state display process.

(17) FIG. 8C is a flowchart of a control content change process.

(18) FIG. 8D is the flowchart of the control content change process.

(19) FIG. 8E is a flowchart of a learning process.

(20) FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram of a learning dataset.

(21) FIG. 10 is an overall diagram of a ResNet.

(22) FIG. 11 is a diagram illustrating a procedure of imaging a three-dimensional temperature distribution.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENT(S)

(23) Hereinafter, the same environmental state **41** may be represented by different expressions, for example, an environmental state (AR) **41A**, an environmental state (CFD) **41C**, and an environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41F**. The environmental state **41** is the state of temperature, humidity, or the like of a space serving as a target of air conditioning performed by an air conditioning apparatus **30**. The environmental state (AR) **41A** is the environmental state **41** that is represented as visualized information for augmented reality (AR). The environmental state (CFD) **41C** is the environmental state **41** that is simulated and represented as computational fluid dynamics (CFD) data. The environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41F** is the environmental state **41** that represented as image data of an environmental distribution diagram. The details of the above will be described below.

(24) The environmental state **41** with “target” or the like attached to the top, such as a target environmental state **41T**, indicates that the former is a broader concept of the latter.

Overall Configuration

(25) An air conditioning control system **100** transmits control content **42** to the air conditioning apparatus **30** and adjusts the environmental state **41** in a target space **81** of an air conditioning operation performed by the air conditioning apparatus **30**. The control content **42** is an air conditioning control parameter including an amount regarding at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity. The target space **81** is, for example, an office in a building. The environmental state **41** is an environmental parameter at one or more locations in the target space **81**. The environmental parameter includes an amount regarding at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity.

(26) In the present embodiment, the air conditioning control system **100** adjusts the environmental state **41** particularly in a partial space **81a**, which is a part of the target space **81**. The partial space **81a** in the present embodiment is a predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space **81**. In the present embodiment, the predetermined two-dimensional region is a plane at a predetermined height in the target space **81**. However, the predetermined two-dimensional region is not limited thereto and may be any region.

(27) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the air conditioning control system **100** mainly includes an air conditioning control apparatus **10**.

(28) FIG. 1A to FIG. 1D are schematic diagrams of the air conditioning control system **100**. As illustrated in FIG. 1A, a user starts up an AR application installed in a user terminal **20** and directs the camera of the user terminal **20** toward the target space **81**. Accordingly, as illustrated in FIG. 1B, the environmental state **41** visualized by AR is displayed on the screen of the user terminal **20**. In FIG. 1B, air blown out of the air conditioning apparatus **30** is displayed. As illustrated in FIG. 1C and FIG. 1D, the user slides his/her finger on the screen of the user terminal **20**, for example, thereby changing the direction of the displayed air to a desired air flow direction. Accordingly, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** determines the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** so that the air flow direction changed by the user is implemented, and transmits the control content **42** to the air conditioning apparatus **30**. As a result, the direction of the air blown out of the air conditioning apparatus **30** changes to the air flow direction changed by the user on the screen.

(29) The air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment performs an environmental state display process, a control content change process, and a learning process. The

environmental state display process is a process of displaying the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** on the screen of the user terminal **20** on the basis of the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30**. FIG. 3A illustrates a configuration diagram of the environmental state display process. The control content change process is a process of changing the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** so as to bring the target space **81** into the environmental state **41** desired by the user. FIG. 3B illustrates a configuration diagram of the control content change process. The learning process is a process of creating a learning model **43** that is to be used in the control content change process and that determines the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30**. FIG. 3C illustrates a configuration diagram of the learning process. These processes will be described in detail in “(3) Processes”.

(30) (2) Detailed Configuration

(31) (2-1) Air Conditioning Control Apparatus

(32) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** mainly includes an acquisition unit **11**, a data conversion unit **12**, a control content determination unit **13**, a simulation unit **14**, a learning unit **15**, and an AR content storage unit **16**. The air conditioning control apparatus **10** also includes a control processing device and a storage device. As the control processing device, a processor such as a CPU or a GPU may be used. The control processing device reads out a program stored in the storage device and performs predetermined image processing or computation processing in accordance with the program. Furthermore, the control processing device is capable of writing a computation result in the storage device and reading out information stored in the storage device in accordance with the program. The acquisition unit **11**, the data conversion unit **12**, the control content determination unit **13**, the simulation unit **14**, the learning unit **15**, and the AR content storage unit **16** illustrated in FIG. 2 are various functional blocks implemented by the control processing device.

(33) The air conditioning control apparatus **10** is connected to the user terminal **20** and the air conditioning apparatus **30** via a communication network **80**, such as the Internet. In the present embodiment, it is assumed that the air conditioning control apparatus **10** is in a cloud. However, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** may be in the target space **81**, and the position thereof is not limited.

(34) (2-1-1) Acquisition Unit

(35) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. 3A, the acquisition unit **11** acquires the control content **42** from the air conditioning apparatus **30**. FIG. 4 illustrates an example of the control content **42**. In FIG. 4, “20° C.” is stored as “temperature”, “50%” is stored as “humidity”, and so forth. As “air volume” and “air velocity”, values representing the respective magnitudes in five stages are stored. In a case where there are a plurality of air conditioning apparatuses **30** in the target space **81**, the acquisition unit **11** acquires pieces of control content **42** for the plurality of air conditioning apparatuses **30**.

(36) In the control content change process illustrated in FIG. 3B, the acquisition unit **11** acquires a target environmental state **41T**, which is the environmental state **41** to be achieved, from the user terminal **20**. The environmental state **41** to be achieved is the environmental state **41** that is designated by the user on the screen of the user terminal **20** and that is desired by the user. In the present embodiment, the target environmental state **41T** is the environmental state **41** to be achieved in a plane at a predetermined height in the target space **81**. In the present embodiment, the acquisition unit **11** acquires the target environmental state **41T** as a target environmental state (AR) **41TA**, which is visualized information for AR.

(37) In the learning process illustrated in FIG. 3C, the acquisition unit **11** acquires learning control content **42L**. The learning control content **42L** is used as an objective variable of the learning model **43**. FIG. 5 illustrates an example of the learning control content **42L**. The learning control content **42L** is data of a combination of various values of temperature, humidity, and so forth that can be taken as set values by the air conditioning apparatus **30**. In a case where there are a plurality

of air conditioning apparatuses **30** in the target space **81**, the acquisition unit **11** acquires pieces of learning control content **42L** for the plurality of air conditioning apparatuses **30**. The acquisition unit **11** acquires the learning control content **42L** from, for example, a CSV file, a DB server, or the like.

(38) (2-1-2) Simulation Unit

(39) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. 3A, the simulation unit **14** simulates the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** on the basis of the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** acquired by the acquisition unit **11**. The simulation unit **14** outputs environmental state (CFD) **41C** as a result of the simulation. The environmental state (CFD) **41C** is simulation data about environmental parameters at individual coordinate points in the target space **81**. FIG. 6 illustrates an example in which the temperature distribution in the target space **81** is visualized by using the environmental state (CFD) **41C**. FIG. 6 illustrates the temperature distribution in a plane at a height of 1 m from the ground in the target space **81**. In FIG. 6, a portion having a high color density indicates a portion having a high temperature.

(40) In the learning process illustrated in FIG. 3C, the simulation unit **14** simulates the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** on the basis of the learning control content **42L** acquired by the acquisition unit **11**. As illustrated in FIG. 5, the learning control content **42L** is constituted by a plurality of sets of control content **42**. Thus, the simulation unit **14** simulates the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** with respect to each set of the control content **42**. The learning environmental state **41L** is an output result of one or more simulations performed by using the learning control content **42L** as an input. In the present embodiment, the learning environmental state **41L** is the environmental state **41** in a plane at a predetermined height in the target space **81**. The simulation unit **14** outputs a learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC** as a result of the simulation. The learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC** is constituted by a plurality of pieces of CFD data corresponding to individual simulations.

(41) The above-described simulation is performed by using, for example, existing general-purpose simulation software.

(42) (2-1-3) Data Conversion Unit

(43) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. 3A, the data conversion unit **12** converts the environmental state (CFD) **41C** output by the simulation unit **14** into environmental state (AR) **41A**, which is visualized information for AR.

(44) In the control content change process illustrated in FIG. 3B, the data conversion unit **12** creates a target environmental state (CFD) **41TC** by using the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** acquired by the acquisition unit **11** and the environmental state (CFD) **41C** output by the simulation unit **14** in the environmental state display process. The target environmental state (AR) **41TA** is visualized information for AR that reflects the environmental state **41** desired by the user. The environmental state (CFD) **41C** is the environmental state **41** in which a desire of the user is not reflected before the user operates the screen of the user terminal **20**. The data conversion unit **12** updates the environmental state (CFD) **41C** by using the target environmental state (AR) **41TA**, thereby creating the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC**, which is the environmental state **41** desired by the user.

(45) In a case where the acquisition unit **11** acquires a plurality of target environmental states (AR) **41TA** from a plurality of user terminals **20** within a relatively short time, for example, 5 seconds or less, the data conversion unit **12** may determine one target environmental state (AR) **41TA** from among these target environmental states (AR) **41TA** by using a predetermined method.

(46) For example, it is assumed that one user designates the temperature of a place A in the target space **81** as 20° C. and that another user designates the temperature of the same place A as 22° C. In such a case where a plurality of target environmental states (AR) **41TA** compete with each other, for example, the plurality of target environmental states (AR) **41TA** may be averaged to determine one target environmental state (AR) **41TA**. In the above-described example, the target

environmental state (AR) **41TA** in which the temperature of the place A is 21° C. is determined. For example, it is assumed that one user designates the temperature of the place A in the target space **81** as 20° C. and that another user designates the temperature of a place B different from the place A as 22° C. In such a case where a plurality of target environmental states (AR) **41TA** do not compete with each other, for example, the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** that faithfully reflects the desires of the respective users may be determined. In the above-described example, the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** in which the temperature of the place A is 20° C. and the temperature of the place B is 22° C. is determined.

(47) The data conversion unit **12** further converts the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC** into a target environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41TF**. The environmental distribution diagram according to the present embodiment is an image of a temperature distribution or the like in a plane at a predetermined height in the target space **81**. The environmental distribution diagram is created for each of environmental parameters, such as temperature and humidity. For example, in the case of an environmental distribution diagram of temperature, the data conversion unit **12** acquires, from the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC**, a temperature distribution in the plane at the predetermined height in the target space **81**. The data conversion unit **12** normalizes the acquired temperature distribution in the plane and images the temperature distribution. The normalization is a process of converting temperatures corresponding to individual pixels into numerical values from 0 to 1. For example, in a case where the maximum temperature in the temperature distribution is 25° C. and the minimum temperature therein is 20° C., values obtained by subtracting 20° C. from the temperatures of the individual pixels are divided by 5° C., which is obtained by subtracting 20° C. from 25° C., and then the temperature values of the individual pixels become values from 0 to 1. Imaging is a visualization process of assigning, to the individual pixels, light or shade corresponding to the magnitudes of the normalized numerical values. FIG. 7A illustrates an example of an environmental distribution diagram of temperature in a plane at a height of 1 m from the ground in the target space **81**. FIG. 7B illustrates an example of an environmental distribution diagram of air velocity created in a similar manner. The data conversion unit **12** outputs, as the target environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41TF**, a plurality of environmental distribution diagrams corresponding to the individual environmental parameters created from the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC**. Hereinafter, a plurality of environmental distribution diagrams created from one piece of CFD data will be referred to as one set of environmental distribution diagrams.

(48) In the learning process illustrated in FIG. 3C, the data conversion unit **12** converts the learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC** output by the simulation unit **14** into a learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF**. As described above, the learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC** is constituted by a plurality of pieces of CFD data, and thus the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** is constituted by a plurality of sets of environmental distribution diagrams. The learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** is used as an explanatory variable of the learning model **43**.

(49) Data conversion may be performed by using, for example, a function of simulation software that creates CFD data, or may be performed by using a programming language, such as Python or R.

(50) (2-1-4) Control Content Determination Unit

(51) The control content determination unit **13** has the learning model **43** having an input, which is the target environmental state **41T**, and an output, which is determined control content **42D**, which is the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** for bringing the target space **81** closer to the target environmental state **41T**. Specifically, in the control content change process illustrated in FIG. 3B, the control content determination unit **13** calculates the determined control content **42D** from the target environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41TF** by using the learning model **43** acquired from the learning unit **15**. In the present

embodiment, the determined control content **42D** is the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** for bringing a plane at a predetermined height in the target space **81** closer to the target environmental state **41T**.

(52) The calculation using the learning model **43** is performed by, for example, a function of a machine learning platform that has created the learning model **43**, or the like.

(53) (2-1-5) Learning Unit

(54) The learning unit **15** creates the learning model **43**. The learning model **43** has been trained by using, as a learning dataset **44L**, the learning control content **42L**, which is the control content **42** for the air conditioning apparatus **30**, and the learning environmental state **41L**, which is the environmental state **41** in the target space **81**. Specifically, in the learning process illustrated in FIG. **3C**, the learning unit **15** acquires the learning control content **42L** from the acquisition unit **11** and acquires the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** from the data conversion unit **12**. The learning unit **15** creates the learning model **43** by using the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** as an explanatory variable and using the learning control content **42L** as an objective variable.

(55) The learning procedure will be specifically described. Here, a description will be given of a case where there is one air conditioning apparatus **30** in the target space **81**. However, there may be a plurality of air conditioning apparatuses **30** in the target space **81**. It is assumed that the air conditioning control parameters constituting the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** are temperature, air volume, and air flow direction. It is assumed that the image size of an environmental distribution diagram is 16 (vertical pixels)×8 (horizontal pixels). FIG. **9** illustrates an overview of the learning dataset **44L**. FIG. **9** illustrates two pieces of learning data. The left side in FIG. **9** illustrates the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** serving as an explanatory variable of the learning model **43**. Here, two sets of environmental distribution diagrams are illustrated. Because there are three air conditioning control parameters constituting the control content **42**, one set of environmental distribution diagrams is constituted by three environmental distribution diagrams as described in “(2-1-3) Data Conversion Unit”. The right side in FIG. **9** illustrates the learning control content **42L** serving as an objective variable of the learning model **43**.

(56) In the present embodiment, a regression model based on a convolutional neural network (hereafter abbreviated as CNN) is used as the learning model **43**. Furthermore, a residual network (ResNet) is used as the CNN. FIG. **10** illustrates an overall view of the ResNet. The ResNet in FIG. **10** is constituted by an input layer IPL, an intermediate layer IML, and an output layer OPL.

(57) As illustrated in FIG. **10**, image data of environmental distribution diagrams is input to the input layer IPL of the ResNet. The input layer IPL of the ResNet is configured to be able to receive a three-dimensional array of (vertical pixels of an environmental distribution diagram)×(horizontal pixels of an environmental distribution diagram)×(the number of environmental distribution diagrams constituting one set of environmental distribution diagrams). This is for inputting one set of environmental distribution diagrams at one time. Here, a three-dimensional array of 16 (vertical pixels)×8 (horizontal pixels)×3 (the number of environmental distribution diagrams) is input to the input layer IPL.

(58) The intermediate layer IML1 of the ResNet is constituted by a residual block illustrated in FIG. **10**. The residual block is constituted by a plurality of convolution layers and a shortcut connection. In the calculation in the residual block in FIG. **10**, an activation function is caused to act on the sum of an input to the upper convolution layer and an output from the lower convolution layer. As the activation function, a rectified linear unit (ReLU) function is used.

(59) As illustrated in FIG. **10**, the intermediate layer IML2 of the ResNet is a fully connected layer (FC layer). As the activation function, a ReLU function is used.

(60) The control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** is output to the output layer OPL of the ResNet. To the output layer OPL of the CNN, a vector having dimensions of (the number of

air conditioning control parameters constituting the control content **42**)×(the number of air conditioning apparatuses **30**) is output. Here, in accordance with **3** (the number of air conditioning control parameters)×**1** (the number of apparatuses), a three-dimensional vector is output to the output layer OPL. To the three nodes (circles) illustrated in the output layer OPL in FIG. **10**, a predicted temperature value, a predicted air volume value, and a predicted air flow direction value are output in this order from above.

(61) As a loss function of the ResNet, for example, a mean squared error or the like is used.

(62) The ResNet is optimized by using, for example, stochastic gradient descent or the like.

(63) In the present embodiment, a ResNet is created as the learning model **43**. However, the learning model **43** may be a CNN having another configuration, an ordinary neural network, or the like. The learning model **43** is created by using, for example, a cloud machine learning platform or the like.

(64) (2-1-6) AR Content Storage Unit

(65) The AR content storage unit **16** stores AR content **16C**. The AR content **16C** is a part such as an image used in AR. The AR content **16C** is, for example, an image of air displayed on the screen of the user terminal **20** as illustrated in FIG. **1B** to FIG. **1D**.

(66) The AR content **16C** is stored in a storage device included in the air conditioning control apparatus **10**.

(67) (2-2) User Terminal

(68) As illustrated in FIG. **2**, the user terminal **20** mainly includes an AR processing unit **21**, an input unit **22**, and an output unit **23**. The user terminal **20** also includes a control processing device and a storage device. As the control processing device, a processor such as a CPU or a GPU may be used. The control processing device reads out a program stored in the storage device and performs predetermined image processing or computation processing in accordance with the program. Furthermore, the control processing device is capable of writing a computation result in the storage device and reading out information stored in the storage device in accordance with the program. The AR processing unit **21**, the input unit **22**, and the output unit **23** illustrated in FIG. **2** are various functional blocks implemented by the control processing device. In the present embodiment, it is assumed that the user terminal **20** is a tablet terminal or a smartphone terminal. However, the user terminal **20** may be a PC or the like, and is not limited. The user terminal **20** is connected to the air conditioning control apparatus **10** and the air conditioning apparatus **30** via the communication network **80**, such as the Internet. The user terminal **20** is in the target space **81**.

(69) (2-2-1) AR Processing Unit

(70) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. **3A**, the AR processing unit **21** acquires the environmental state (AR data) **41A** and the AR content **16C** from the air conditioning control apparatus **10**. The AR processing unit **21** also acquires, from the input unit **22**, image information **25** in the target space **81**. The image information **25** is acquired by the input unit **22** from the camera included in the user terminal **20**. The AR processing unit **21** combines these pieces of information to create AR image information **24**.

(71) In the control content change process illustrated in FIG. **3B**, the AR processing unit **21** acquires, from the input unit **22**, the AR image information **24** that reflects the environmental state **41** desired by the user. The AR processing unit **21** extracts, from the AR image information **24**, the target environmental state (AR) **41TA**, which is visualized information for AR.

(72) The AR processing unit **21** is implemented by, for example, a function of an existing general-purpose AR application. The AR application is used by being installed in the user terminal **20**.

(73) (2-2-2) Input Unit

(74) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. **3A**, the input unit **22** acquires the image information **25** in the target space **81** from the camera included in the user terminal **20**.

(75) In the control content change process illustrated in FIG. **3B**, the input unit **22** acquires, from the screen of the user terminal **20**, the AR image information **24** that reflects the environmental

state **41** desired by the user. The user slides his/her finger on an AR image displayed on the screen of the user terminal **20**, thereby designating the environmental state **41** desired by the user. FIG. **1C** and FIG. **1D** illustrate a state in which the user is operating an AR image indicating an air flow direction with his/her finger. The AR image information **24** acquired by the input unit **22** is processed into the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** by the AR processing unit **21**. Thus, the target environmental state **41T** is determined on the basis of a desire regarding the environmental state **41** input via the screen of the user terminal **20**, which is a user interface.

(76) (2-2-3) Output Unit

(77) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. **3A**, the output unit **23** acquires the AR image information **24** from the AR processing unit **21** and outputs the AR image information **24** to the screen of the user terminal **20**. Accordingly, the user is able to view, on the screen of the user terminal **20**, the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** visualized by AR. FIG. **1B** illustrates a state in which the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** visualized by AR is displayed on the screen of the user terminal **20**.

(78) (2-3) Air Conditioning Apparatus

(79) As illustrated in FIG. **2**, the air conditioning apparatus **30** mainly includes a control unit **31**. The air conditioning apparatus **30** is connected to the air conditioning control apparatus **10** and the user terminal **20** via the communication network **80**, such as the Internet. The air conditioning apparatus **30** is in the target space **81**.

(80) (2-3-1) Control Unit

(81) The control unit **31** controls, on the basis of the control content **42**, the temperature, humidity, and so forth of air discharged from the air conditioning apparatus **30**.

(82) In the environmental state display process illustrated in FIG. **3A**, the control unit **31** transmits the control content **42** to the air conditioning control apparatus **10**.

(83) In the control content change process illustrated in FIG. **3B**, the control unit **31** acquires the determined control content **42D** from the air conditioning control apparatus **10**. As a result of the control unit **31** controlling the air conditioning apparatus **30** on the basis of the determined control content **42D**, the target space **81** is brought into the environmental state **41** desired by the user.

(84) (3) Processes

(85) As described above, the air conditioning control system **100** performs an environmental state display process, a control content change process, and a learning process. Hereinafter, the individual processes will be described in detail.

(86) (3-1) Environmental State Display Process

(87) The environmental state display process is a process of displaying the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** on the screen of the user terminal **20** on the basis of the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30**. The environmental state display process will be described with reference to the flowchart in FIG. **8A** and FIG. **8B**. The flowchart in FIG. **8A** and FIG. **8B** basically corresponds to the arrows in FIG. **3A**.

(88) Upon startup of the AR application in step **S1**, the user terminal **20** requests the environmental state (AR) **41A** and the AR content **16C** to the air conditioning control apparatus **10** in step **S2**.

(89) In response to receipt of the request from the user terminal **20**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** acquires the control content **42** from the air conditioning apparatus **30** in step **S3**.

(90) After acquiring the control content **42** from the air conditioning apparatus **30**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** simulates the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** on the basis of the control content **42** and creates the environmental state (CFD) **41C** in step **S4**.

(91) After creating the environmental state (CFD) **41C**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** converts the environmental state (CFD) **41C** into the environmental state (AR) **41A** in step **S5**.

(92) After converting the environmental state (CFD) **41C** into the environmental state (AR) **41A**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** transmits the environmental state (AR) **41A** and the AR content **16C** to the user terminal **20** in step **S6**.

- (93) In response to acquisition of the environmental state (AR) **41A** and the AR content **16C** from the air conditioning control apparatus **10**, the user terminal **20** acquires the image information **25** from the camera of the user terminal **20** in step **S7**.
- (94) After acquiring the environmental state (AR) **41A**, the AR content **16C**, and the image information **25**, the user terminal **20** creates the AR image information **24** in step **S8**.
- (95) After creating the AR image information **24**, the user terminal **20** displays the AR image information **24** on the screen of the user terminal **20** in step **S9**.
- (96) (3-2) Control Content Change Process
- (97) The control content change process is a process of changing the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** so as to bring the target space **81** into the environmental state **41** desired by the user. The control content change process will be described with reference to the flowchart in FIG. **8C** and FIG. **8D**. The flowchart in FIG. **8C** and FIG. **8D** basically corresponds to the arrows in FIG. **3B**. Here, it is assumed that the AR image information **24** is displayed on the screen of the user terminal **20** by the environmental state display process.
- (98) In response to an operation performed on the AR image on the screen in step **S1**, the user terminal **20** acquires the AR image information **24** that reflects the environmental state **41** desired by the user in step **S2**.
- (99) After acquiring the AR image information **24**, the user terminal **20** extracts the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** from the AR image information **24** in step **S3**.
- (100) After extracting the target environmental state (AR) **41TA**, the user terminal **20** transmits the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** to the air conditioning control apparatus **10** in step **S4**.
- (101) In response to acquisition of the target environmental state (AR) **41TA**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** creates the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC** by using the target environmental state (AR) **41TA** and the environmental state (CFD) **41C** created in the environmental state display process in step **S5**.
- (102) After creating the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** converts the target environmental state (CFD) **41TC** into the target environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41TF** in step **S6**.
- (103) After acquiring the target environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41TF**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** calculates the determined control content **42D** by using the learning model **43** in step **S7**.
- (104) After calculating the determined control content **42D**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** transmits the determined control content **42D** to the air conditioning apparatus **30** in step **S8**.
- (105) In response to acquisition of the determined control content **42D**, the air conditioning apparatus **30** controls the air conditioning apparatus **30** on the basis of the determined control content **42D** in step **S9**.
- (106) After calculating the determined control content **42D**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** performs an environmental state display process on the basis of the determined control content **42D** in step **S10**. Specifically, step **S3** in FIG. **8A** is changed to “acquire determined control content **42D**”, and the environmental state display process is started from step **S3**. The determined control content **42D** is calculated from the screen operated by the user, and thus the screen display is basically the same as the screen display obtained through the environmental state display process performed on the basis of the determined control content **42D**. However, the determined control content **42D** is predicted by the learning model **43**, and thus the two screen displays may be slightly different from each other. It is also necessary to update the environmental state (CFD) **41C** of the simulation unit **14** to a state corresponding to the determined control content **42D**. Thus, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** performs the environmental state display process on the basis of the determined control content **42D**.
- (107) (3-3) Learning Process
- (108) The learning process is a process of creating a learning model **43** that is to be used in the

control content change process and that determines the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30**. The learning process will be described with reference to the flowchart in FIG. **8E**. The flowchart in FIG. **8E** basically corresponds to the arrows in FIG. **3C**.

(109) The air conditioning control apparatus **10** acquires the learning control content **42L** in step **S1**.

(110) After acquiring the learning control content **42L**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** simulates the environmental state **41** in the target space **81** on the basis of the learning control content **42L** and creates the learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC** in step **S2**.

(111) After creating the learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** converts the learning environmental state (CFD) **41LC** into the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** in step **S3**.

(112) After acquiring the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF**, the air conditioning control apparatus **10** creates the learning model **43** by using the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** as an explanatory variable and using the learning control content **42L** as an objective variable in step **S4**.

(113) (4) Features

(114) 4-1

(115) In an air conditioning control system according to the related art, the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** is determined by reinforcement learning so as to bring the target space **81** closer to the environmental state **41** desired by a user.

(116) However, in reinforcement learning, a reward function is determined in accordance with the environmental state **41** desired by the user, a value function is learned by using the reward function, and the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** is determined. Thus, in a case where the control content **42** of the air conditioning apparatus **30** is to be determined in real time, the method using reinforcement learning involves an issue that a relatively long time is taken.

(117) The air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment determines the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** by using the trained learning model **43**. Thus, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of determining the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** more quickly and in more real time than in the case of using reinforcement learning.

(118) 4-2

(119) In the air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment, the target environmental state **41T** is the environmental state **41** to be achieved in the partial space **81a**, which is a part of the target space **81**. The determined control content **42D** is the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** for bringing the partial space **81a** closer to the target environmental state **41T**. The learning environmental state **41L** is the environmental state **41** in the partial space **81a**. Thus, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of bringing a part of the target space **81** into the environmental state **42** to be achieved in a pinpoint manner.

(120) 4-3

(121) In the air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment, the partial space **81a** is a predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space **81**. Thus, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of bringing the predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space **81** into the environmental state **41** to be achieved.

(122) 4-4

(123) The air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment performs a simulation to create the learning dataset **44L** of the learning model **43**. Thus, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of easily acquiring the learning dataset **44L**.

(124) 4-5

(125) In the air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment, the user operates the screen of the user terminal **20**, which is a user interface, to set the desired

environmental state **41**. Thus, the user is able to easily set the desired environmental state **41**.

(126) (5) Modifications

(127) (5-1) Modification **1A**

(128) The learning dataset **44L** may further include space layout information **45**, which is information on an object in the target space **81**. The space layout information **45** includes, as the information on the object in the target space **81**, information regarding the position of the object and the amount of heat of the object. The position of the object is acquired from, for example, an object detection camera or the like. The amount of heat is acquired from, for example, a thermographic camera or the like.

(129) The learning dataset **44L** may further include arrangement information **46** of one or more air outlets of one or more air conditioning apparatuses **30**. The arrangement information **46** can be acquired at the time of defining the target space **81**.

(130) The space layout information **45** and the arrangement information **46** are reflected in the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF**. Specifically, the air conditioning control system **100** creates CFD data by using not only the control content **42** but also the space layout information **45** and the arrangement information **46** in the simulation unit **14** in the environmental state display process and the learning process. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **3D**, as a result of using the space layout information **45** and the arrangement information **46** in the simulation unit **14** in the learning process, the space layout information **45** and the arrangement information **46** are reflected in the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF**.

(131) As a result of including the space layout information **45** and the arrangement information **46** in the learning dataset **44L**, the amount of information to be learned by the learning model **43** increases, and the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of increasing the accuracy of the determined control content **42D** output by the learning model **43**.

(132) (5-2) Modification **1B**

(133) In the present embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. **3C**, the air conditioning control system **100** creates the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** by simulation. However, the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** may be created from actual measurement values of various sensors installed in the target space **81** and corresponding to individual environmental parameters. For example, to create an environmental distribution diagram of temperature, a temperature distribution in a plane at a predetermined height from the ground is acquired from actual measurement values of a temperature sensor or the like. The method of creating an environmental distribution diagram of temperature from the temperature distribution in the plane at the predetermined height from the ground is as described in “(2-1-3) Data Conversion Unit”.

(134) As a result of creating the learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF** not from simulation but from the actual measurement values of an environmental parameter, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of creating a more accurate learning environmental state (environmental distribution diagram) **41LF**. As a result, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of increasing the accuracy of the determined control content **42D** output by the learning model **43**.

(135) (5-3) Modification **1C**

(136) The air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment uses AR so as to enable the user to grasp the current environmental state **41** in the target space **81** and designate the environmental state **41** desired by the user. However, to achieve the above-described purpose, the air conditioning control system **100** may use virtual reality (VR), mixed reality (MR), substitutional reality (SR), or the like.

(137) (5-4) Modification **1D**

(138) In the air conditioning control system **100** according to the present embodiment, the partial

space **81a** is a predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space **81**. However, the partial space **81a** may be a predetermined three-dimensional region in the target space **81**. As a result, the air conditioning control system **100** is capable of bringing the predetermined three-dimensional region in the target space **81** into the environmental state **41** to be achieved.

(139) In the present modification, the predetermined three-dimensional region is a three-dimensional rectangular region surrounding a workspace or the like of a human. However, the predetermined three-dimensional region is not limited thereto and may be any region.

(140) (5-4-1) Acquisition Unit

(141) In the present modification, the target environmental state **41T** acquired by the acquisition unit **11** is the environmental state **41** in a three-dimensional rectangular region in the target space **81**.

(142) (5-4-2) Simulation Unit

(143) In the present modification, the learning environmental state **41L**, simulated by the simulation unit **14** is the environmental state **41** in a three-dimensional rectangular region in the target space **81**.

(144) (5-4-3) Data Conversion Unit

(145) In the present modification, an environmental distribution diagram created by the data conversion unit **12** is an image of a temperature distribution or the like in a three-dimensional rectangular region in the target space **81**. FIG. **11** is a diagram illustrating a procedure of imaging a three-dimensional temperature distribution. As illustrated on the left in FIG. **11**, the data conversion unit **12** first divides a three-dimensional rectangular region into rectangular unit blocks. In FIG. **11**, the three-dimensional rectangular region is divided into unit blocks of 5 (width)×4 (height)×4 (depth). At this time, each unit block includes at least one simulation point of temperature or the like. Subsequently, the data conversion unit **12** aggregates values of temperature included in each unit block. As the aggregation, for example, an average value of one or more temperatures included in each unit block is calculated. As a result, one temperature is determined for each unit block. Subsequently, as illustrated in the center in FIG. **11**, the data conversion unit **12** divides the three-dimensional rectangular region in the height direction. In the center in FIG. **11**, the three-dimensional rectangular region is divided into four blocks. Each unit block is associated with one temperature, and thus the four blocks can be regarded as four planes in which each pixel has a temperature value, as illustrated on the right in FIG. **11**. The four planes are environmental distribution diagrams obtained by imaging a temperature distribution in the three-dimensional rectangular region. The environmental distribution diagram is created for each of environmental parameters, such as temperature and humidity. Thus, in FIG. **11**, for example, in the case of creating environmental distribution diagrams for temperature and humidity, two (temperature and humidity) environmental distribution diagrams are created for each of the planes, and thus eight environmental distribution diagrams are created in total. In general, in the case of creating environmental distribution diagrams for N environmental parameters in a three-dimensional rectangular region of W (width)×H (height)×D (depth), the number of environmental distribution diagrams in one set is H×N, and each environmental distribution diagram has the number of pixels of W×D. In the above description, the three-dimensional rectangular region is divided in the height direction, but the three-dimensional rectangular region may be divided in the width direction or the depth direction.

(146) (5-4-4) Control Content Determination Unit

(147) In the present modification, the determined control content **42D** calculated by the control content determination unit **13** is the control content **42** to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus **30** for bringing the three-dimensional rectangular region in the target space **81** closer to the target environmental state **41T**.

(148) (5-4-5) Learning Unit

(149) In the present modification, the learning unit **15** creates the learning model **43** in a manner

similar to that in the present embodiment.

(150) 5-5

(151) The embodiment of the present disclosure has been described above. It is to be understood that the embodiment and the details can be variously changed without deviating from the gist and scope of the present disclosure described in the claims.

Claims

1. An air conditioning control system configured to transmit determined control content to an air conditioning apparatus and adjust an environmental state in a target space of an air conditioning operation performed by the air conditioning apparatus, the air conditioning control system comprising: a processor; and a storage, the processor being configured to acquire a target environmental state to which the environmental state is to be adjusted, the target environmental state being represented as image data created based on a simulation of the environmental state in the target space using current control content of the air conditioning apparatus; and use a learning model to create the determined control content based on the image data, the learning model having an input and an output, the input being the image data and the output being the determined control content, and transmit the determined control content to the air conditioning apparatus in order to bring the target space to the target environmental state, the learning model having been trained by using, as a learning dataset, learning control content and a learning environmental state, the learning environmental state being created by simulating the environmental state in the target space based on the learning control content, the learning environmental state being represented as learning image data.
2. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the target environmental state is the environmental state to be achieved in a partial space, the partial space being a part of the target space, the determined control content is the control content to be transmitted to the air conditioning apparatus in order to bring the partial space closer to the target environmental state, and the learning environmental state relates to the partial space.
3. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the partial space is a predetermined three-dimensional region in the target space.
4. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the partial space is a predetermined two-dimensional region in the target space.
5. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the learning environmental state is an output result of one or more simulations performed by using the learning control content as an input.
6. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the determined control content is an air conditioning control parameter including a value relating to at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity.
7. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the environmental state is an environmental parameter at one or more locations in the target space, and the environmental parameter includes a value relating to at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity.
8. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the target environmental state is determined based on a desire relating to the environmental state input via a user interface.
9. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the learning dataset further includes space layout information, the space layout information being information on an object in the target space.
10. The air conditioning control system according to claim 9, wherein the space layout information includes, as the information on the object in the target space, information regarding an amount of heat.

11. The air conditioning control system according to claim 2, wherein the learning dataset further includes arrangement information of one or more air outlets of one or more air conditioning apparatuses.
 12. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the learning environmental state is created by performing a plurality of simulations performed by using the learning control content.
 13. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the determined control content is an air conditioning control parameter including a value relating to at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity.
 14. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the environmental state is an environmental parameter at one or more locations in the target space, and the environmental parameter includes a value relating to at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, and air velocity.
 15. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the target environmental state is determined based on the simulation and a desire relating to the environmental state input via a user interface.
 16. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the learning dataset further includes space layout information, the space layout information being information on an object in the target space.
 17. The air conditioning control system according to claim 16, wherein the space layout information includes, as the information on the object in the target space, information regarding an amount of heat.
 18. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the learning dataset further includes arrangement information of one or more air outlets of one or more air conditioning apparatuses.
 19. The air conditioning control system according to claim 1, wherein the image data represents an environmental distribution diagram of an environmental parameter, the environmental parameter being a value related to at least one of temperature, humidity, air flow direction, air volume, or air velocity in the target space.
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